
417 Wildlife Alliance Business Plan

Status: Draft for founder review

Date: 2026-05-16

Primary region: Southwest Missouri / 417 area

This plan is operational guidance, not legal or tax advice. Before launch, 417 Wildlife Alliance should have a Missouri nonprofit attorney or CPA review the formation filings, IRS application, donation language, grant/reimbursement policy, and any wildlife-handling commitments.

1. Executive Summary

417 Wildlife Alliance should launch as a Missouri nonprofit public benefit corporation that supports licensed and permitted wildlife rehabilitators, connects the public to safe wildlife guidance, and builds a transparent local funding network for injured, orphaned, displaced, and at-risk wildlife in the 417 region.

The first version should not try to become a direct wildlife rehabilitation facility unless the organization has the required Missouri and federal permits, qualified personnel, approved facilities, veterinary support, and records process. The cleanest launch model is:

1. Public education and found-animal routing.
2. A rehabber support fund for supplies, transport, emergency needs, and approved micro-grants or reimbursements.
3. A privacy-aware directory of licensed/permitted rehabbers and organizations.
4. Partner and sponsor programs.
5. A future Wildlife Compassionate Company program for tree care and other wildlife-adjacent businesses.

The website already matches this direction: it includes found-animal intake, donation checkout scaffolding, rehabber directory pages, partner applications, certified-company pages, stories, FAQ, merch, Supabase tables, Stripe checkout, and admin shells. The next business step is not more page count. The next step is legal formation, donation readiness, and operating discipline.

2. Mission, Vision, And Positioning

Mission

417 Wildlife Alliance helps people help wildlife by routing found animals to appropriate licensed or permitted care, funding the people and organizations doing rehabilitation work, and educating the community to prevent avoidable wildlife harm.

Vision

Southwest Missouri becomes a place where people know what to do when wildlife is in trouble, rehabbers have more reliable support, and local businesses understand how to reduce displacement and injury before it happens.

Positioning Statement

417 Wildlife Alliance is the regional wildlife-help hub and rehabber support fund for the 417 area.

Launch Promise

Helping people help wildlife, and helping rehabbers keep saying yes.

3. Legal And Operating Assumptions

These assumptions should be approved by the founding board:

- 417 Wildlife Alliance will be formed in Missouri as a nonprofit public benefit corporation.
- The organization will apply for federal 501(c)(3) public charity recognition.
- It will initially route, fund, educate, and coordinate. It will not directly rehabilitate, possess, transport, or hold wildlife unless and until the required state and federal permits are in place.
- Donations will not be advertised as tax-deductible until one of these is true:
 - the IRS has issued the 501(c)(3) determination letter, or
 - donations are received through a qualified fiscal sponsor that can issue tax receipts.
- If the organization publicly solicits donations in Missouri before receiving 501(c)(3), it should register with the Missouri Attorney General before soliciting.
- Fund categories on the website should be treated as donor preferences unless the board formally accepts legally restricted gifts and has accounting controls for restricted funds.

4. Programs

Program 1: Found-Animal Help And Routing

Purpose: give the public calm, safe next steps and route cases to appropriate licensed/permitted care.

MVP activities:

- Collect finder contact info, species, location, urgency, photos, and consent to share.
- Provide immediate safety guidance without medical treatment instructions.
- Route to a rehabber, organization, MDC resource, veterinarian, or reunification resource when appropriate.
- Protect private rehabber addresses and finder contact information.

Operating rule:

- The website should never imply that unlicensed members of the public may keep, feed, treat, or rehabilitate wildlife.
- If the organization itself begins transporting or holding wildlife, the board must pause the program until permits, insurance, training, and records are approved.

Program 2: Wildlife Rehabilitation Support Fund

Purpose: make small, practical rehab expenses fundable and trackable.

Eligible support:

- Formula and feeding supplies.
- Cages, bedding, enrichment, and cleaning supplies.
- Emergency medical supplies or veterinary invoices.
- Transport costs.
- Approved micro-grants or reimbursements to licensed/permitted rehabbers and rehabilitation nonprofits.

Fund controls:

- Require recipient identity, license/permit status when applicable, species scope, service area, and conflict-of-interest screening.

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- Use written criteria for approvals.
 - Prefer reimbursements against receipts at launch.
 - Do not pay insiders or related parties without board review, documentation, and conflict recusal.
 - Track each disbursement by recipient, purpose, amount, date, receipt/invoice, approving board/staff member, and outcome.

Program 3: Rehabber Directory

Purpose: help residents find appropriate help without exposing private information or overwhelming rehabbers.

Directory rules:

- Publish only consented public contact details.
- Display species categories, county/service area, and intake status.
- Include "last verified" dates.
- Keep private phone, address, permit documents, and capacity notes admin-only.
- Give rehabbers a way to pause public intake status.

Program 4: Education And Prevention

Purpose: reduce unsafe public handling and prevent avoidable displacement.

Initial content:

- Baby animal decision trees.
- "Do not feed" and "call before acting" guidance.
- Seasonal nesting and denning alerts.
- Tree work and landscaping wildlife-awareness resources.
- Local impact stories.

Program 5: Partners, Sponsors, And Certified Companies

Purpose: build reliable revenue and prevention partnerships.

Partner categories:

- Veterinary partners.
- Tree care companies.
- Landscaping companies.
- Pest and wildlife conflict companies.
- Local businesses and wellness brands.
- Schools and community groups.
- Corporate sponsors.

Certified-company launch rule:

- At launch, call this an education and recognition program, not a guarantee or legal accreditation.
- Use clear criteria, annual renewal, public code of conduct, and revocation rights.
- Avoid language that implies 417 Wildlife Alliance guarantees a company's work.

5. Revenue Model

Revenue Streams

1. Individual donations.
2. Monthly donors.
3. Founding sponsors.
4. Business partner/sponsor packages.
5. Certified-company education/application fees after criteria are approved.
6. Grants.
7. Events and community fundraisers.
8. Merch or print-on-demand proceeds.

Recommended Year 1 Revenue Targets

These are planning targets, not promises:

Revenue source	Year 1 target
One-time individual donations	\$15,000
Monthly donors	\$18,000
Founding sponsors	\$20,000
Certified-company pilot fees	\$5,000
Small grants	\$5,000
Events/merch net	\$2,000
Total	\$65,000

Three-Year Growth Target

Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Public donations	\$33,000	\$62,000	\$105,000
Sponsors/partners	\$20,000	\$35,000	\$55,000
Grants	\$5,000	\$25,000	\$55,000
Certified/company program	\$5,000	\$10,000	\$18,000
Events/merch net	\$2,000	\$3,000	\$7,000
Total	\$65,000	\$135,000	\$240,000

Expense Model

Recommended allocation once the organization is operating:

Expense category	Target share
Rehabber support and animal-care grants/reimbursements	45%
Operations, software, insurance, admin, website	15%
Fundraising and donor communications	12%
Education and certified-company program	8%

Expense category	Target share
Professional support, legal, accounting, compliance	10%
Reserve	10%

Startup Budget

Item	Estimated cost
Missouri nonprofit Articles of Incorporation filing	\$25
Missouri charitable registration if required before IRS exemption	\$15
IRS Form 1023-EZ user fee, if eligible	\$275
IRS Form 1023 user fee, if not EZ eligible	\$600
Attorney/CPA formation review	\$1,500 to \$5,000
Insurance review and initial policy	\$750 to \$3,000
Accounting/bookkeeping setup	\$300 to \$1,200
Donation processor setup	\$0 to \$500
Initial print/sticker/materials	\$300 to \$1,500

Because the Year 1 plan projects more than \$50,000 in gross receipts, the organization should expect to use full IRS Form 1023 unless the board intentionally lowers launch revenue expectations and the 1023-EZ eligibility worksheet confirms eligibility.

6. Website Business Plan

The website should be the public operating system for the fund, not just a brochure.

Core Website Jobs

1. Help someone who found an animal make a safer next move.
2. Convert donors into one-time and monthly supporters.
3. Build trust with transparent fund priorities and impact reporting.
4. Recruit rehabbers, volunteers, partners, sponsors, and certified-company applicants.
5. Give admins structured records for grants, accounting, and follow-up.

Required Launch Pages

The current app already scaffolds these:

- Home.
- Found an animal.
- Rehabber directory.
- Donate.
- How you can help.
- Partners.
- Certified companies.
- About.

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- Stories/news.
 - FAQ.
 - Merch or coming soon.
 - Admin dashboard.

Website Changes Before Taking Donations

Add or confirm:

- Tax status banner on the donate page.
- EIN field once issued.
- 501(c)(3) status language once approved.
- Fiscal sponsor language if using a sponsor.
- Donation receipt email template.
- Refund policy and contact email.
- Privacy policy.
- Terms/disclaimer.
- Fund restriction language.
- Admin export for donations, fund preferences, donor email, Stripe session ID, and receipt status.
- Board-approved gift acceptance policy.

Donation Page Language

Before IRS approval and without fiscal sponsor:

> 417 Wildlife Alliance is forming as a Missouri nonprofit and applying for federal 501(c)(3) recognition. Donations support the wildlife rehabilitation support mission. We are not currently representing donations as tax-deductible unless and until IRS recognition is confirmed. Please consult your tax advisor.

With fiscal sponsor:

> Donations for 417 Wildlife Alliance are received by [Fiscal Sponsor Legal Name], a 501(c)(3) public charity, for restricted use in support of the 417 Wildlife Alliance project. Receipts are issued by [Fiscal Sponsor].

After IRS approval:

> 417 Wildlife Alliance is a 501(c)(3) public charity. EIN: [EIN]. Contributions are tax-deductible to the extent allowed by law. No goods or services were provided in exchange for this contribution unless stated on the receipt.

Found-Animal Page Language

Use:

> 417 Wildlife Alliance is not a 24/7 emergency service unless explicitly stated. Do not feed, medicate, bathe, or keep wildlife unless instructed by a licensed/permitted rehabilitator or appropriate authority.

Avoid:

- "We will rescue the animal."
- "Bring it to us."
- "We treat wildlife."
- Any medical care instructions not approved by qualified professionals.

Certified Company Page Language

Use:

> Wildlife Compassionate Company recognition means the company completed 417 Wildlife Alliance education and agreed to follow a wildlife-aware escalation process. It is not a guarantee of performance and does not replace licensing, insurance, safety rules, or applicable law.

7. Exact Steps To Become A Missouri Nonprofit And Accept Donations

Fastest Tax-Deductible Donation Path: Fiscal Sponsorship

If the founders need tax-deductible donations immediately, use a fiscal sponsor while forming 417 Wildlife Alliance.

Steps:

1. Identify a 501(c)(3) fiscal sponsor aligned with animal welfare, wildlife rehabilitation, conservation, or community education.
2. Apply to the sponsor with the mission, budget, activities, founders, website, and fund controls.
3. Sign a written fiscal sponsorship agreement covering fees, donation ownership, project restrictions, payment approvals, reporting, intellectual property, termination, and transfer of assets.
4. Route the website Donate button either to the sponsor's donation page or to a processor account owned/approved by the sponsor.
5. Use only sponsor-approved donation language.
6. Keep separate project records so funds can transfer cleanly if 417 Wildlife Alliance later receives its own 501(c)(3) determination.

This is the cleanest way to accept tax-deductible gifts before the IRS issues 417 Wildlife Alliance its own determination letter.

Own 501(c)(3) Path

Step 1: Confirm Name And Legal Structure

1. Search Missouri Secretary of State business records for "417 Wildlife Alliance".
2. If available, reserve or file under that name.
3. Form as a Missouri nonprofit corporation, designated as a public benefit corporation.
4. Decide whether the corporation will have voting members. Recommendation: no statutory members for launch; governance stays with the board.

Step 2: Recruit Founding Board

Missouri's nonprofit corporation instruction sheet says at least three directors are required. Recruit at least three unrelated, independent directors if possible.

Recommended board roles:

- President or Chair.
- Secretary.
- Treasurer.
- Program/Wildlife advisor.
- Fundraising/community partnerships advisor.

The same person may hold more than one officer role under the Missouri form instructions, but for grant readiness and donor trust, separate Treasurer from President/Chair if possible.

Step 3: Choose Registered Agent

1. Choose a Missouri registered agent.
2. Use a Missouri physical street address. A P.O. box alone is not acceptable for the registered office.
3. Make sure the agent can receive legal and Secretary of State notices reliably.

Step 4: Draft Articles Of Incorporation

Use Missouri Corp. 52 or online filing.

Include:

- Legal name.
- Public benefit designation.
- Perpetual duration.
- Missouri registered agent and physical address.
- Incorporator name and address.
- Whether the corporation has members.
- Dissolution clause.
- Charitable/educational/scientific 501(c)(3) purpose clause.
- No private inurement clause.
- No substantial lobbying and no political campaign intervention clause.
- Operational limitation clause.
- Specific purpose language for 417 Wildlife Alliance.

Recommended purpose language:

> The corporation is organized exclusively for charitable, educational, and scientific purposes within the meaning of Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, including supporting licensed and permitted wildlife rehabilitation, educating the public on safe and lawful wildlife response, reducing preventable wildlife harm, and funding supplies, transport, emergency care, and other charitable support for wildlife rehabilitation in Missouri and surrounding regions.

Recommended launch-specific limitation:

> The corporation will not directly possess, transport, hold, treat, or rehabilitate wildlife unless it has obtained all required state and federal permits and approvals.

Step 5: File Missouri Articles

1. File online with the Missouri Secretary of State or mail Corp. 52.
2. Current Corp. 52 filing fee: \$25.
3. Keep the stamped Articles/Certificate of Incorporation.
4. Save the Missouri charter number.

Step 6: Hold First Board Meeting

At the organizational meeting, approve:

- Bylaws.
- Conflict-of-interest policy.
- Initial officers.

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- Fiscal year, recommended calendar year unless CPA says otherwise.
 - Bank account and authorized signers.
 - EIN application authorization.
 - IRS Form 1023 or 1023-EZ authorization.
 - Donation acceptance policy.
 - Fund restriction policy.
 - Grant/reimbursement policy for rehabber support.
 - Website donation language.
 - Recordkeeping and document retention policy.
 - Privacy/data policy.
 - Insurance review.
 - No-direct-rehabilitation policy until permits exist.

Keep signed minutes.

Step 7: Apply For EIN

1. Apply directly with the IRS after Missouri formation.
2. Use the legal organization name exactly as filed.
3. Use a responsible party's SSN or taxpayer ID.
4. Save the EIN confirmation letter.

The IRS says legal entities should form through the state before applying for an EIN.

Step 8: Open Bank Account And Accounting System

Bring:

- Filed Articles/Certificate of Incorporation.
- EIN letter.
- Board resolution authorizing account/signers.
- Officer IDs.
- Bylaws if requested.

Set up:

- Separate operating and restricted-fund tracking.
- Accounting categories for each website fund preference.
- Receipt storage.
- Donor records.
- Monthly reconciliation.
- Board financial reports.

Do not run donations through a founder's personal account.

Step 9: Decide Between IRS Form 1023 And 1023-EZ

Use Form 1023-EZ only if the organization completes the IRS eligibility worksheet and qualifies. IRS instructions say if any worksheet answer is "Yes," the organization must use Form 1023 instead.

Reasons 417 Wildlife Alliance may need full Form 1023:

- Planned Year 1 gross receipts exceed \$50,000.
- The organization wants grant readiness.
- The fund may make grants or reimbursements to independent rehabbers.
- The certified-company program may create more complex revenue and public-benefit questions.
- Donors, sponsors, and grantors may prefer a full reviewed application.

Recommendation: use full Form 1023 unless the founding board intentionally keeps the first three years smaller and a nonprofit attorney/CPA confirms 1023-EZ eligibility.

Step 10: Prepare IRS 501(c)(3) Application

Prepare:

- Articles with required 501(c)(3) clauses.
- Bylaws.
- Conflict-of-interest policy.
- Board list.
- Narrative of activities.
- Three-year financial projections.
- Fundraising plan.
- Grant/reimbursement policy.
- Compensation policy, if any.
- Website screenshots or draft copy.
- Donation receipt language.
- Explanation that the organization funds and routes to licensed/permitted rehabbers and does not directly rehabilitate wildlife unless permits are obtained.

File:

- Form 1023 or 1023-EZ through Pay.gov.
- Current IRS user fees listed by IRS: \$600 for Form 1023, \$275 for Form 1023-EZ.

If filed within 27 months after legal formation and approved, IRS instructions generally allow exempt status to be effective as of the legal formation date. Still, do not promise donors tax deductibility before approval unless using a fiscal sponsor.

Step 11: Missouri Charitable Solicitation Registration

Before soliciting donations in Missouri, determine whether registration with the Missouri Attorney General is required.

Practical rule:

- If 417 Wildlife Alliance does not yet have 501(c)(3), register before soliciting in Missouri unless counsel confirms another exemption.
- If it has 501(c)(3), the Missouri Attorney General initial registration form says 501(c)(3), 501(c)(7), and 501(c)(8) organizations are exempt from registration and should not submit the form.

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- If using a fiscal sponsor, confirm whether the sponsor's registration/exemption covers the solicitation and exactly how donation pages must identify the sponsor.

Initial registration packet if required:

- Missouri AG Charitable Organization Initial Registration Statement.
- \$15 fee.
- Articles of Incorporation attached.
- Officers and directors information.
- Solicitation locations.
- Tax status marked "none" if no IRS letter yet.

Annual renewal:

- If registered, Missouri AG FAQs say the annual renewal is due within 75 days after the end of the fiscal year and requires a \$15 fee.
- Once 501(c)(3) is received, request counsel/AG confirmation on exemption handling and whether to request an exemption letter.

Step 12: Configure Donation Processor

Use the organization's EIN and bank account, not a personal account.

Processor checklist:

- Legal name and DBA, if any.
- EIN.
- Bank account.
- Authorized representative.
- Tax status language.
- Refund policy.
- Website URL.
- Donation categories.
- Monthly donation option.
- Webhook for successful payments.
- Receipt email.
- Exportable records.

In this app, the donation code is already structured for Stripe Checkout and a Stripe webhook. Before public launch, add:

- STRIPE_SECRET_KEY.
- STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET.
- Production site URL.
- Donation success/failure pages.
- Receipt email workflow.
- Admin donation export.
- Tax-status copy on the Donate page.

Step 13: Issue Receipts Correctly

For each donation, store:

- Donor name if provided.
- Donor email.
- Date.
- Amount.
- Fund preference.
- Payment processor ID.
- Receipt sent date.
- Goods/services statement.

For tax-deductible receipts after IRS approval or through a fiscal sponsor, include:

- Organization name.
- Amount of cash contribution.
- Description of noncash contribution, if any, but not value.
- Statement that no goods or services were provided, if true.
- If goods/services were provided, description and good-faith estimate of value.
- EIN after 417 Wildlife Alliance has one.

IRS rules make written acknowledgment especially important for single contributions of \$250 or more, and written disclosure is required for quid pro quo contributions over \$75.

Step 14: Apply For Missouri Sales/Use Tax Exemption

After IRS exemption is received, apply to the Missouri Department of Revenue for a Missouri Sales or Use Tax Exemption Letter using Form 1746.

Attach:

- Completed Form 1746.
- IRS determination letter.
- Missouri Certificate of Incorporation/Registration.
- Bylaws.
- Financial statement for the years in existence, or a one-year projected budget if less than six months old.

Important:

- Federal 501(c)(3) status does not automatically mean Missouri sales/use tax exemption.
- If the organization sells merch or other tangible goods, confirm sales tax collection and retail sales license obligations with a CPA or Missouri DOR. Sales of tangible personal property are generally presumed taxable unless exempted.

Step 15: Wildlife Permit Decision

For launch, 417 Wildlife Alliance should operate as a fund/routing/education organization, not a rehab facility.

If the organization wants to directly take, possess, transport, hold, or rehabilitate wildlife:

1. Contact Missouri Department of Conservation before launching that activity.
2. Identify qualified permit holders and responsible personnel.

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3. Apply for the Missouri Wildlife Rehabilitation Permit if the organization will hold wildlife for rehabilitation.
 4. Obtain any required federal permits for migratory birds.
 5. Create facility, sanitation, veterinary, public safety, recordkeeping, and inspection procedures.
 6. Update insurance before handling wildlife.

Missouri's wildlife rehabilitation permit rule covers taking, possessing, transporting, and holding sick or injured Missouri wildlife for rehabilitation, and permit holders must keep current animal records. Federal rules require a migratory bird rehabilitation permit to take, temporarily possess, or transport migratory birds for rehabilitation purposes, with a limited allowance for a finder to possess a bird for immediate transport to a permitted rehabilitator or licensed veterinarian.

Step 16: Annual Compliance Calendar

Every year:

- Missouri Secretary of State nonprofit annual report, currently due August 31 per the nonprofit instruction sheet.
- IRS Form 990-N, 990-EZ, or 990, depending on gross receipts and assets.
- Missouri Attorney General renewal if still registered and not exempt, due within 75 days after fiscal year end.
- Board meeting minutes and financial review.
- Registered agent and address check.
- Donation receipt year-end summary.
- Insurance renewal.
- Rehabber directory re-verification.
- Conflict-of-interest disclosures.
- Sales/use tax filings if merch or taxable sales require them.
- Update public annual impact report.

Failure to file required IRS annual returns for three consecutive years can automatically revoke federal tax-exempt status.

8. Governance Policies Needed Before Launch

Minimum:

- Bylaws.
- Conflict-of-interest policy.
- Gift acceptance policy.
- Donor privacy policy.
- Document retention policy.
- Whistleblower policy.
- Expense reimbursement policy.
- Fund restriction policy.
- Grant/reimbursement policy.
- Volunteer policy.
- Animal handling and no-direct-rehab policy.
- Photo/media release policy.
- Data privacy and case confidentiality policy.

9. Rehabber Support Grant/Reimbursement Policy

Purpose:

Support licensed/permitted wildlife rehabilitators and nonprofit rehabilitation organizations with documented expenses that further 417 Wildlife Alliance's charitable and educational mission.

Eligibility:

- Recipient must be a licensed/permitted rehabber, a rehabilitation nonprofit, a veterinarian, or another approved mission-aligned provider.
- Recipient must be in or serving the 417 region unless the board approves a special case.
- Recipient must provide permit/license status where applicable.
- Recipient must not be barred by conflict of interest.

Eligible expenses:

- Formula, food, feeding supplies.
- Caging and bedding.
- Emergency medical care.
- Transport fuel or mileage reimbursement.
- Release-site support.
- Safety and sanitation supplies.
- Approved educational or prevention materials.

Approval process:

1. Recipient submits request or reimbursement form.
2. Admin screens for eligibility and conflict.
3. Program lead recommends approval.
4. Treasurer or board designee approves under a board-set threshold.
5. Full board approves over-threshold or insider-related requests.
6. Payment is made by check, ACH, or documented card transaction.
7. Receipt and outcome are stored.

Controls:

- No cash payments at launch.
- No undocumented restricted gifts to individuals.
- No payments for personal pet care.
- No payments to board members or relatives without conflict review and board recusal.
- Publish aggregate impact, not private recipient details unless consented.

10. Marketing And Launch Strategy

Audiences

- People who found animals.
- Wildlife rehabilitators and nonprofits.
- Local donors.
- Tree care, landscaping, pest control, veterinary, and pet/wellness businesses.
- Community groups, schools, and local media.
- Grantmakers and civic partners.

Launch Campaigns

1. Founding 100 monthly donors.
2. Baby season formula fund.
3. Sponsor a rehabber supply shelf.
4. Wildlife-aware tree care pilot.
5. Transport and emergency support fund.
6. Impact story series.

Trust Signals

- Board names and roles.
- Tax status and EIN.
- Clear donation use categories.
- Annual impact report.
- Directory verification dates.
- Named sponsors.
- Written grant/reimbursement criteria.
- Public privacy and safety policies.

11. Key Metrics

Program metrics:

- Found-animal submissions.
- Cases routed.
- Average first response time.
- Rehabbers listed.
- Counties served.
- Species categories served.
- Education page views.

Fund metrics:

- One-time donations.
- Monthly recurring donors.
- Donor retention.
- Total raised.
- Total disbursed.
- Supplies funded.
- Rehabbers/organizations supported.
- Average grant/reimbursement amount.

Partner metrics:

- Sponsor leads.
- Approved sponsors.
- Certified-company applicants.
- Training completions.
- Renewals.

Website metrics:

- Donate conversion rate.
- Found-animal form completion rate.
- Directory searches.
- Newsletter signups.
- Admin response completion.

12. 90-Day Launch Plan

Days 1-15: Formation Decisions

- Approve mission, legal structure, and no-direct-rehab launch boundary.
- Recruit at least three directors.
- Confirm registered agent.
- Search name availability.
- Draft Articles, bylaws, conflict policy, and initial board resolutions.
- Decide fiscal sponsor vs own pending-determination fundraising.

Days 16-30: Missouri Formation And Internal Controls

- File Missouri nonprofit Articles.
- Hold first board meeting.
- Apply for EIN.
- Open bank account.
- Set up accounting.

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- Approve donation acceptance and grant/reimbursement policies.
 - Prepare donation page legal copy.

Days 31-60: IRS And Donation Readiness

- Prepare and file IRS Form 1023 or 1023-EZ.
- Register with Missouri AG if soliciting before 501(c)(3) and not covered by fiscal sponsor.
- Configure Stripe or chosen processor.
- Add receipt workflow.
- Add privacy, terms, refund, and status pages.
- Build donor/admin export.

Days 61-90: Soft Launch

- Verify initial rehabber contacts and listing consent.
- Recruit first sponsors.
- Launch founding donor campaign.
- Publish first education resources.
- Pilot case intake with defined response hours.
- Publish first impact update.
- Review legal/compliance gaps before broad public launch.

13. Immediate Action Checklist

Founders should do these next:

1. Choose fiscal sponsorship or direct 501(c)(3) path.
2. Confirm whether 417 Wildlife Alliance will launch as routing/funding only.
3. Recruit at least three directors.
4. Choose registered agent and physical Missouri address.
5. Draft and file Missouri nonprofit Articles with 501(c)(3) clauses.
6. Hold first board meeting and approve policies.
7. Apply for EIN.
8. Open bank account.
9. File IRS Form 1023 or 1023-EZ.
10. Register with Missouri AG before solicitation if no 501(c)(3) exemption or fiscal sponsor coverage.
11. Add compliant donation language to the website.
12. Configure donation processor under the organization or fiscal sponsor.
13. Build receipt and donation-record exports.
14. Verify rehabber directory consent and permit notes.
15. Publish first launch campaign only after donation status language is correct.

14. Source Links

Official sources checked for this plan:

- Missouri Secretary of State, Starting a Business: <https://www.sos.mo.gov/business/corporations/startBusiness.asp>
- Missouri Secretary of State, Corp. 52 Nonprofit Articles and instruction sheet: <https://www.sos.mo.gov/CMSImages/Business/corp52.pdf>
- Missouri Secretary of State, General Services and Annual Reports: <https://www.sos.mo.gov/business/corporations/generalInfo>
- Missouri Attorney General, Charity Registration FAQs: <https://ago.mo.gov/get-help/programs-services-from-a-z/charity/for-no-profits/registration-faqs/>
- Missouri Attorney General, Charitable Organization Initial Registration Statement: <https://app.ago.mo.gov/docs/default-source/pdf-forms/charityinitial.pdf?sfvrsn=2>
- Missouri statute Section 407.462, charitable solicitation registration: <https://revisor.mo.gov/main/OneSection.aspx?section=407.462>
- IRS, How to apply for 501(c)(3) status: <https://www.irs.gov/charities-non-profits/how-to-apply-for-501c3-status>
- IRS, Form 1023: <https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1023>
- IRS, Form 1023-EZ: <https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1023-ez>
- IRS, Form 1023-EZ instructions: <https://www.irs.gov/instructions/i1023ez>
- IRS, Form 1023 and 1023-EZ user fees: <https://www.irs.gov/charities-non-profits/form-1023-and-1023-ez-amount-of-user-fee>
- IRS, EIN application guidance: <https://www.irs.gov/businesses/small-businesses-self-employed/get-an-employer-identification-number>
- IRS, Annual filing and forms: <https://www.irs.gov/charities-non-profits/annual-filing-and-forms>
- IRS, Publication 1771 donation substantiation: <https://www.irs.gov/pub/irs-pdf/p1771.pdf>
- Missouri Department of Revenue, Form 1746 Sales or Use Tax Exemption Application: <https://dor.mo.gov/forms/1746.pdf>
- Missouri Department of Revenue, Sales/Use Tax: <https://dor.mo.gov/taxation/business/tax-types/sales-use/>
- Missouri Department of Conservation permits overview: <https://mdc.mo.gov/permits>
- Missouri Code of State Regulations, 3 CSR 10-9.415 Wildlife Rehabilitation Permit: <https://s1.sos.mo.gov/cmsimages/adrules/csr/current/3csr/3c10-9.pdf>
- U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, Migratory Bird Rehabilitation permit: <https://www.fws.gov/service/3-200-10b-migratory-bird-rehabilitation>
- U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, 3-200-10b application page: <https://www.fws.gov/media/3-200-10b-application-migratory-bird-rehabilitation>
- 50 CFR 21.76 rehabilitation permits: <https://www.law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/50/21.76>